

(CAD) to highly specialised software for niche requirements. You may have noticed the dramatic exclusion of games from the list. If you want to play a lot of games on your computer, Linux is not for you. Very few big publishers release games for Linux (id Software being one of them), and this is mostly because the market for Linux games is very small. That does not mean that there are no games for Linux, but games with the bells and whistles that can exploit your graphics card to the fullest do not exist.

Linux is also not for some specialised professional use. This includes layout artists, graphic designers and multimedia editors. Although competent programs are available for home use, Gimp or Inkscape do *not* really measure up to Photoshop or Corel Draw, and there is definitely nothing that comes close to the utility of Quark Xpress and InDesign. There are ways to emulate the windows environment to get some of these programs to work on Linux. You can also purchase some software for Linux, like Corel Draw and Maya. These are small issues. There is plenty of reason why you should use linux.

Linux is no longer the domain of the technological elite. There are many distros that can be used by “human beings” for regular day-to-day purposes.

It is a great and cheap solution for office use. Linux can be used to revive and use an outdated computer system that no longer supports the latest release of Windows. The upgrades are regular, and easily manageable. You can carry around your system on a portable hard disk, and use it on every system you connect it to, without changing the system.

This is technically possible for Windows too, but is illegal. Most importantly, Linux is free, and you own your copy. You can do whatever you want with it, install it on as many machines as you please, and not bother to read the fine print in the process. You certainly cannot be on the wrong side of the law when you run Linux.